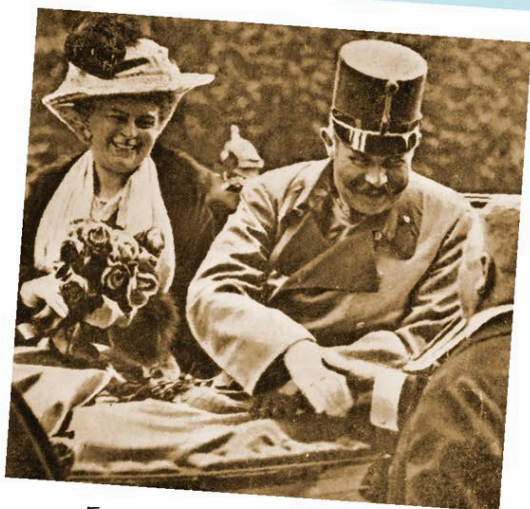


World War I

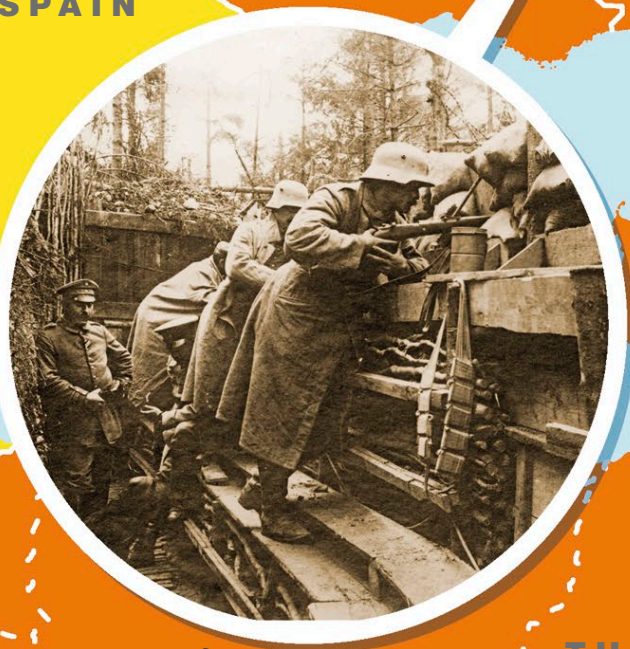
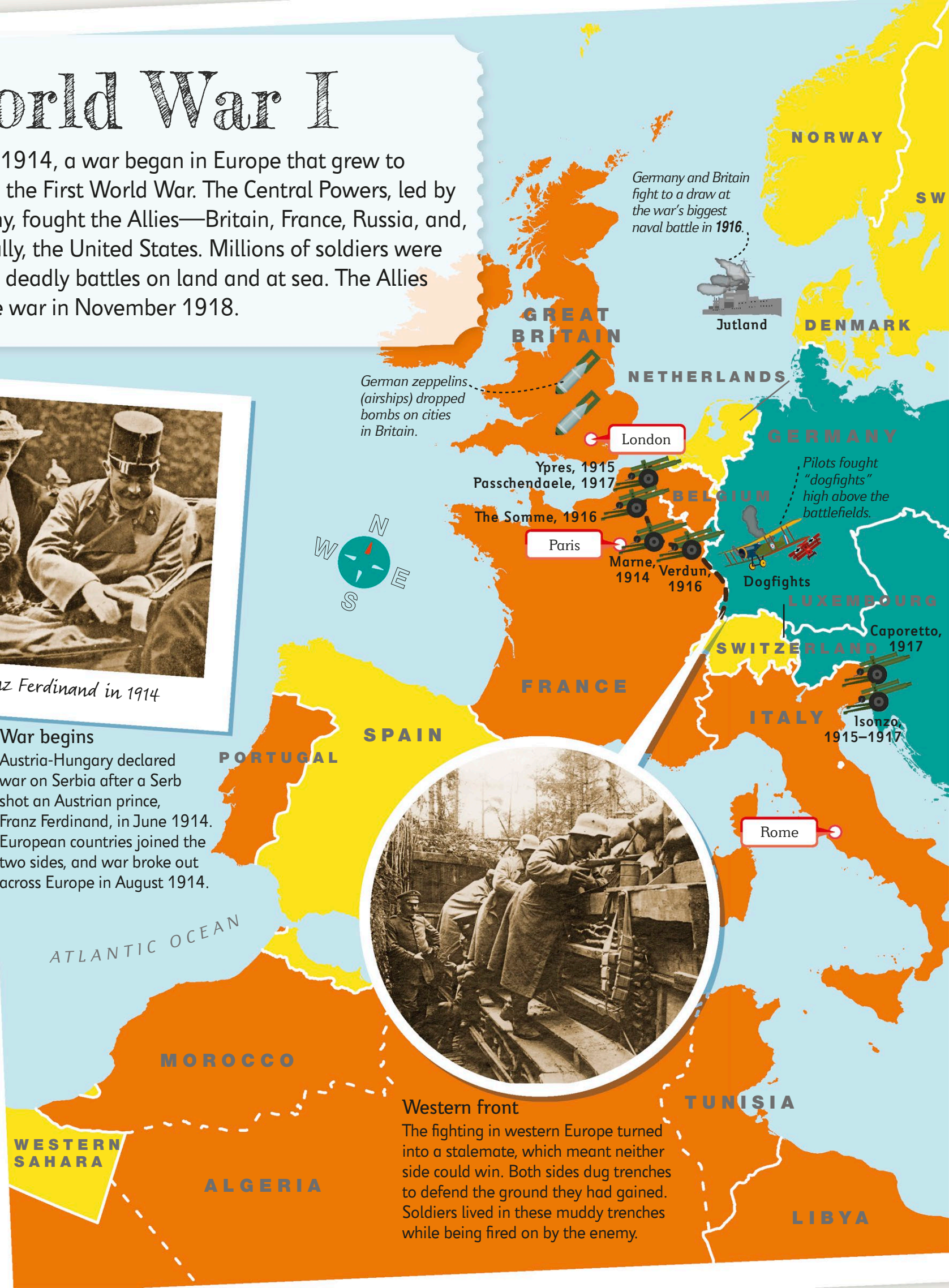
In June 1914, a war began in Europe that grew to become the First World War. The Central Powers, led by Germany, fought the Allies—Britain, France, Russia, and, eventually, the United States. Millions of soldiers were killed in deadly battles on land and at sea. The Allies won the war in November 1918.



Franz Ferdinand in 1914

War begins

Austria-Hungary declared war on Serbia after a Serb shot an Austrian prince, Franz Ferdinand, in June 1914. European countries joined the two sides, and war broke out across Europe in August 1914.



Western front

The fighting in western Europe turned into a stalemate, which meant neither side could win. Both sides dug trenches to defend the ground they had gained. Soldiers lived in these muddy trenches while being fired on by the enemy.